PHILIPPINE STARTUP CHALLENGE XI

TEAM ANNERA

RELAYA

CONCEPT NOTE

I. SUMMARY

In a live English call, the hardest part is often not understanding the client. It is answering them. Many locals know exactly what they want to say, but by the time they have built the sentence in English, the moment has passed. RELAYA is a proposed AI communication tool designed for that moment. Unlike a translator, it does not simply convert words from one language to another. It works out what the user means, even when it comes out as a quick mix of Filipino and English, and turns it into one clear, confident English sentence. RELAYA helps professionals express what they already mean, without taking control of their communication.

RELAYA works alongside the meeting platforms people already use, in two ways. In Say it yourself mode, the default, RELAYA shows the clear English sentence in its panel and the user says it in their own voice, on any platform. In Speak for me mode, the user pastes the meeting link from Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams, and a clearly labeled RELAYA agent joins the call and speaks the sentence for them. In both modes, nothing reaches the call until the user has seen the sentence, and Context Guard first flags any change to numbers, dates, names, negation, or certainty.

RELAYA is designed first for Filipino remote professionals, such as freelancers, developers, and virtual assistants, who regularly speak with international clients or teammates in English video calls and who naturally code-switch between Filipino and English. Our first target market is the Philippines. The problem, however, is not unique to Filipinos. Professionals in other Asian and non-native English-speaking countries, such as Japan, South Korea, Vietnam, and Indonesia, also understand their clients well but struggle to speak clearly in English in real time. Because RELAYA interprets intent rather than serving one fixed language pair, these markets are a natural direction once the product is validated.

RELAYA is at the development stage as of writing. The product, architecture, cost model, and validation plan are designed, and a working prototype is expected at the time of pitching. Before funding, the team will interview target users, test both

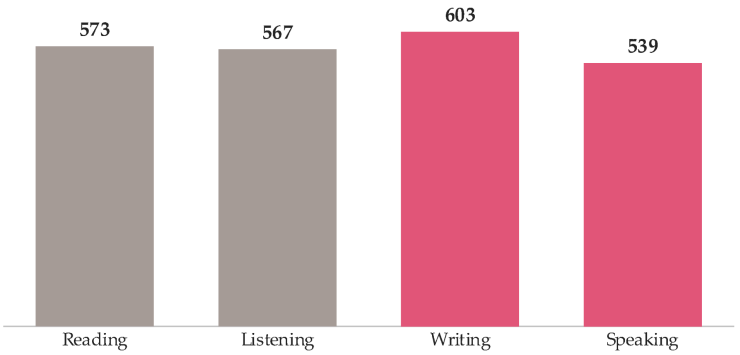
delivery modes with a simulated version of RELAYA, compare speech recognition engines on Tagalog-English and Bisaya-English audio, and build a prototype, including Speak for me on Google Meet, with its own time and free tools. This project asks for PHP 80,000 to move the prototype to cloud infrastructure, add Zoom and Microsoft Teams, and run a six-month validation and pilot with at least 30 target users. The team designs, builds, and maintains RELAYA itself, so the budget contains no engineering costs. These steps are set out in the Operations Plan and Financial Requirement sections.

II. BACKGROUND OF THE PROBLEM

As professional work becomes increasingly global, many people communicate in a language that is not their first or strongest language. Although they may understand an issue and know what they want to say, they may still struggle to formulate their thoughts quickly and naturally in another language. This difficulty becomes more noticeable during live meetings, client interactions, presentations, and other situations where there is little time to prepare a response.

The Philippines provides a relevant example of this problem. The country ranks 28th globally in English proficiency, with an EF EPI score of 569, above the global average of 488. However, its writing score of 603 is 64 points higher than its speaking score of 539, suggesting a difference between written and spoken English performance (EF Education First, 2025).

Figure 1. English proficiency scores of the Philippines by skill, EF EPI 2025 (0 to 800 scale)



Source: EF Education First (2025).

The pressure of live conversation makes this gap matter more. Across ten languages studied, the gap between one speaker finishing and the next starting stays within roughly 250 milliseconds of the cross-language average (Stivers et al., 2009), which leaves very little time to build a sentence in a second language. Language habits at home add to the challenge. Tagalog is the language generally spoken at home in 39.9% of Philippine households, with Bisaya/Binisaya (16.0%) and Cebuano (6.5%) together accounting for another 22.5% (Philippine Statistics Authority, 2023). Researchers describe Tagalog-English code-switching as extremely common in the Philippines (Herrera et al., 2022), which is the kind of input RELAYA is designed to handle.

From this, our team identified a gap between knowing what to say and being able to say it effectively in the moment. The gap is widest in live calls. While the user is still building an English sentence in their head, the conversation moves on. They may lose the chance to contribute, or say something weaker than what they actually know, even though they understood the discussion well.

Existing tools already show that people use AI for communication support. A study found that 46% of surveyed Filipino workers use generative AI monthly for work, with writing tasks being its most common work-related use at 50% (Jobstreet by SEEK, 2024). However, existing tools do not fully address the specific gap RELAYA targets. Translation tools primarily convert content between languages, while grammar and writing tools improve already-formed messages. General AI assistants can rewrite or generate responses, but they are not designed around a live call. Meeting translators such as Talo translate speech between two languages, and meeting assistants such as Otter and Fireflies focus mainly on recording, transcribing, and summarizing conversations. None of them helps users build their own response, from their own mixed-language thoughts, during a live interaction.

The Philippines provides a strong initial context for this problem because of its multilingual population, widespread use of English in professional settings, and growing digital workforce. Filipino professionals such as freelancers, developers, and virtual assistants often communicate with international clients and colleagues while naturally moving between English, Filipino, and local languages such as Bisaya. This makes the Philippines a suitable initial market for developing and testing RELAYA.

III. PROPOSED STARTUP SOLUTION

RELAYA is an AI communication tool for professional video calls that acts as the user's interpreter of intent. It does one job well which is to turn what the user said in their own natural mix of languages into one clear English sentence, and it lets that sentence reach the call only after the user has seen it, either in the user's own voice or through a labeled RELAYA agent.

How it works. The user holds a key and speaks in whatever mix of Filipino and English. RELAYA infers the intended meaning and proposes one clear sentence in a natural, professional tone. The user sets the tone once per call (Casual or Professional) instead of choosing for every sentence, and then delivers the sentence in one of two modes.

Works where the meeting already happens. RELAYA is not a new meeting app. It is a web app that sits beside the meeting. Say it yourself mode needs only the panel and the user's own microphone, so it works with any meeting platform. For Speak for me mode, the user pastes the meeting link and the agent joins Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams as a participant. One reconstruction engine sits behind a small adapter for each platform, so the panel and approval flow stay the same whichever platform the client chooses. The agent is built for Google Meet first and for Zoom and Microsoft Teams next (see Operations Plan).

Two Delivery Modes

1. **Say it yourself (default)**

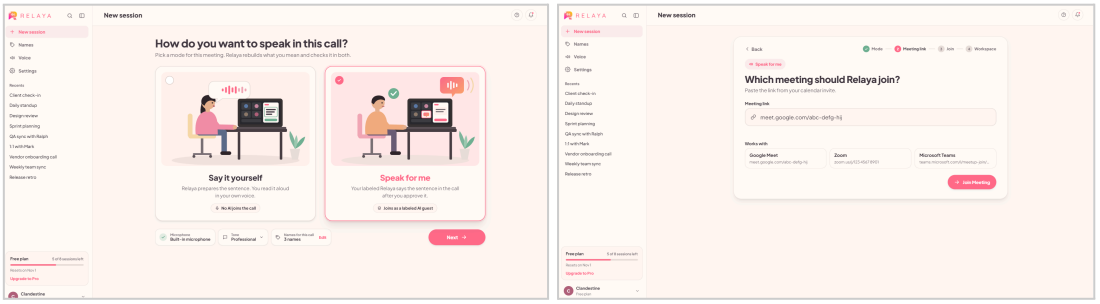
   RELAYA shows the approved sentence in large type in its panel, and the user says it through their own microphone. Reading the sentence aloud is the user's approval, since the user cannot say what they have not read. No agent joins the call, nothing is installed, and the client simply hears the user. This mode works on any meeting platform, has no text-to-speech delay, and doubles as speaking practice.

2. **Speak for me (optional)**

   The user presses 'approve', and a RELAYA agent in the meeting speaks the sentence in its own voice. The agent joins with the user's name in its display label, for example "Janelle's Relaya (AI)," and is always transparent about being an AI participant. Speak for me suits longer explanations, status updates, demos, users with a stutter or another speech difficulty, users who are anxious about speaking, and calls where the user's

own audio is poor. It is not meant for quick back-and-forth, where a second voice and the extra step slow the conversation down.

How The Agent Enters The Call



The user chooses a mode in the RELAYA web app before the call starts, and the agent joins only when Speak for me is chosen. The user pastes the meeting link, the agent asks to join as a labeled guest, and it stays silent and muted until the user approves a sentence. To switch to Speak for me during a call, the user goes back to the web app, changes the mode, and pastes the meeting link, the same setup as at the start. Before the agent first speaks, the user can give a short heads-up such as "I'll have my assistant read this part." If a host does not admit the agent, or the setup fails, the user simply continues in Say it yourself mode, so a call never depends on the agent. RELAYA never plays the agent's voice through the user's own microphone.

The user's workflow in both modes is:

1. The user holds a key in the RELAYA panel. While RELAYA records, the user is muted in the meeting.
2. RELAYA listens to the user's microphone only.
3. The user speaks naturally in their own language or mix. A provisional transcript can appear while they speak, but no English is shown until they finish, because Filipino and Bisaya sentences often end with a hedge or a negation that changes the meaning.
4. When the key is released, RELAYA proposes one clear sentence of 25 words or fewer.
5. If Context Guard marks the sentence Clear, the user can approve it with one key press. If it finds a change, the changed words are highlighted in place with a one-tap fix, such as Keep "maybe." If

RELAYA is unsure it kept the meaning, it offers Re-record or Show literal.

6. The user can record again, make a small edit, or approve.
7. In Say it yourself mode, the user unmutes and reads the sentence aloud. In Speak for me mode, the agent plays the sentence, and a Stop button cuts playback at any time.
8. The client hears a clear English sentence in the user's own voice, or from the labeled RELAYA agent.

The user's own microphone and the agent's audio are separate. The user can always speak directly in the meeting with their own microphone, and RELAYA keeps the agent from talking over the user. On easy turns, the user simply speaks; RELAYA is meant for the hard moments, such as pricing, scope, deadlines, and explaining a problem, where the user would otherwise pause or say something weaker than they mean. Before a hard turn, the user can say a short bridging line in their own voice, such as "Let me put that precisely," to cover the pause.

Per-call names list. Before the call, the user can type the client's name, product names, and key dates or prices. Context Guard checks every proposed sentence against this list, so the details that would do the most harm if changed are protected from the first call, without a stored glossary.

Preserve my voice (planned after the pilot). Preserve my voice will control how far RELAYA moves away from the user's own wording. When it is on, RELAYA keeps the user's word choices, sentence order, and any English phrases that are already clear, and changes only what is needed to be understood, such as grammar, missing words, and the Filipino or Bisaya parts rendered in English. It changes delivery, never meaning, and it does not clone or imitate the user's audio voice.

The examples below show typical inputs from a Filipino developer on a client call. They are design examples that show the intended output.

Table 1. Illustrative examples of RELAYA's proposed sentence and Context Guard result

Stage	Example 1 (Tagalog and English)	Example 2 (Bisaya and English)
You said	"Pwede ba nating i-move ang deadline kasi hindi pa tapos ang backend?"	"Siguro ma-finish nato next week."

Stage	Example 1 (Tagalog and English)	Example 2 (Bisaya and English)
RELAYA proposes	"Can we move the deadline? The backend isn't finished yet."	"We will finish next week."
Context Guard	Clear. No change to dates, numbers, names, negation, or certainty. One key press to approve.	Certainty changed: "siguro" (maybe) was dropped. One-tap fix: Keep "maybe."
Sentence delivered	"Can we move the deadline? The backend isn't finished yet."	"We'll probably finish next week."

Note: Context Guard protects meaning, not just grammar. In the second example, the draft turns a maybe into a promise. Context Guard flags the change before anything is said, and one tap restores the hedge, so RELAYA never makes a promise the user did not make.

RELAYA supports four (4) Sustainable Development Goals, with SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth and SDG 17: Partnerships for the Goals as its primary priorities.

SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth. RELAYA helps professionals communicate more effectively in international work environments, particularly freelancers, developers, and other knowledge workers who regularly interact with clients and colleagues from different countries.

SDG 17: Partnerships for the Goals. RELAYA supports collaboration across languages and countries by making communication more accessible between people with different linguistic backgrounds. Its use in international teams, client relationships, and organizations can help reduce communication barriers and strengthen cross-border professional partnerships.

SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities. RELAYA addresses differences in communication opportunities that can arise when a person's ability to express their knowledge is limited by language.

SDG 4: Quality Education. RELAYA can also support students who understand academic concepts but have difficulty expressing their ideas in English. In online classes, recitations, and presentations held over video calls, it can help students

participate more effectively, and Say It Yourself mode lets them practice saying clear models of their own ideas in their own voice.

HOW RELAYA IMPROVES THE DELIVERY PROCESS

RELAYA's process innovation is in how speaking support reaches the user. Today, a Filipino professional who wants help in the middle of a call has two options: (a) prepare scripts before the call or (b) switch to a separate AI app, speak or type into it, read the answer, switch back, and say it from memory. RELAYA moves that support inside the call. Neither the user nor the client installs anything. The Say It Yourself works beside any meeting app, the agent for Speak for me joins from a pasted link, and the same panel and approval step work on every supported platform. Table 2 compares the two workflows.

Table 2. Actions needed to deliver one sentence with help during a live call

Step	Separate AI app during a call	RELAYA
1	Switch to another app or device	Hold the speak button in the panel
2	Speak or type the thought	Speak naturally in any mix of Filipino, Bisaya, and English
3	Read the answer; ask again if it is too long or too formal	Read one sentence; Context Guard flags meaning changes
4	Switch back to the call and unmute	Press one key to approve
5	Say the sentence from memory or while reading it	The user reads it aloud (Say it yourself), or the agent speaks it (Speak for me)
Meaning check	None	Numbers, dates, names, negation, and certainty

Response time. RELAYA cannot answer within a normal turn gap. Every assisted turn includes the user's private recording, the processing, and the user's reading of the sentence, and reading alone takes a fluent reader about four seconds for a 15-word sentence (Brysbaert, 2019). RELAYA's goal is therefore narrower and testable. On hard turns, the client should wait no longer than they would for the user's unaided answer, and the answer should be clearer and more accurate. The design removes every wait that is not essential:

- Push-to-talk ends the recording the moment the key is released, instead of waiting for silence.

- Transcription and reconstruction run in one server pipeline, so the audio does not return to the browser between steps, and connections are kept warm.
- The model writes one short sentence, plus the meaning facts Context Guard needs, in the same call. One short output is faster than several versions with explanations.
- Context Guard's rule check takes milliseconds, and a second check runs only on high-risk sentences, while the user reads.
- In Speak for me mode, the agent's audio is generated while the user is still reading, so approval plays it at once. This audio never plays without approval, any edit discards it, and the agent stays connected for the whole call.
- RELAYA is used only for the hard turns. On easy turns, the user just speaks.

Design targets. Table 3 lists the targets the first version must meet. They are hypotheses to be tested. The controlled test in the Operations Plan compares RELAYA with the user's unaided answers and with ChatGPT used beside the call.

Table 3. Design targets for the first version

Metric	Target for the first version	How it is measured
End of speech to proposed sentence	Median 1.5 seconds or less; 90% within 3 seconds	Timestamps at each stage, from a Philippine connection
Time to review and approve	Median 4 seconds or less (low-risk); 10 seconds or less (high-risk)	Panel events
Approval to agent audio (Speak for me)	Median 0.7 seconds or less	Audio timestamp on a second device
Client's wait on hard turns	No longer than for the user's unaided answer	Recordings of the controlled test
Sentences approved without changes	60% or more	Panel logs
Sentences edited or re-recorded	25% or less	Panel logs
Critical meaning errors in approved sentences	Zero in the test set	Blind bilingual raters
Context Guard on planted changes	Catches 95% or more; false alarms on 10% or fewer of clean sentences	Planted-error test set

Metric	Target for the first version	How it is measured
Client acceptance of Speak for me	60% or more rate it acceptable	Mock-client ratings

Cost to the user. The realistic paid alternative for this job is a general AI assistant used beside the call. In the Philippines, ChatGPT Go is listed at PHP 300 and ChatGPT Plus at PHP 999 per month (OpenTheRank, 2026). RELAYA's test range of PHP 249 to PHP 399 is close to ChatGPT Go and well below ChatGPT Plus (Figure 3), while removing the app switching and adding the meaning check.

IV. OBJECTIVES

MVP Objectives

1. Build the RELAYA web panel and engine: push-to-talk capture, transcription, and reconstruction of code-switched input into one clear English sentence, with Say it yourself mode working beside any meeting platform.
2. Build the Speak for me agent behind a platform adapter, so the same engine, panel, and approval step work on Google Meet first and then on Zoom and Microsoft Teams.
3. Make Context Guard flag every change to numbers, dates, names, negation, and certainty before the user approves a sentence, with the changed words highlighted in place.
4. Protect client names and product terms through a per-call names list, so they are never rewritten.
5. Ship a stable version that runs end-to-end without manual intervention, with a recorded walkthrough as a backup for demonstrations.
6. Meet the design targets in Table 3 for response time, accuracy, and Context Guard performance.

Validation Objectives

1. Test reconstruction quality with at least 30 target users over a two-month period.
2. Measure how often users approve a proposed sentence without editing it. Target: 60 percent or higher in the first test cohort.
3. Measure how often users choose Say it yourself versus Speak for me, and how clients rate each mode.

4. Collect qualitative feedback on whether users feel more confident communicating after two weeks of use.
5. Identify the top three input categories where reconstruction fails or degrades, and document them openly.
6. Before the pilot, measure end-to-end response time on at least 50 recorded utterances and report the median and 90th percentile.
7. Test Context Guard on at least 50 sentence pairs with planted meaning changes, and report how many it catches and how many false alarms it raises.
8. Survey 30 to 50 target users on willingness to pay, weekly English client calls, and acceptance of a labeled AI agent speaking for them.
9. Before funding, interview 15 to 20 target users and test both delivery modes with a simulated version of RELAYA (see Validation Plan).
10. Before building, compare speech recognition engines on Tagalog-English and Bisaya-English audio, measuring accuracy on numbers, names, negation, and hedges.

Business Objectives

1. Reach 300+ monthly active users in the Philippines within the first six months after launch.
2. Reach a 25 percent week-four retention rate among active users.
3. Establish at least one paid pilot with a small team or workplace, billed as individual seats until the Teams tier launches.
4. Publish an internal report on reconstruction accuracy by input category, updated quarterly.
5. Maintain a clear privacy posture, including no storage of meeting audio beyond what is required for transcription.

V. TARGET MARKET/BENEFICIARIES

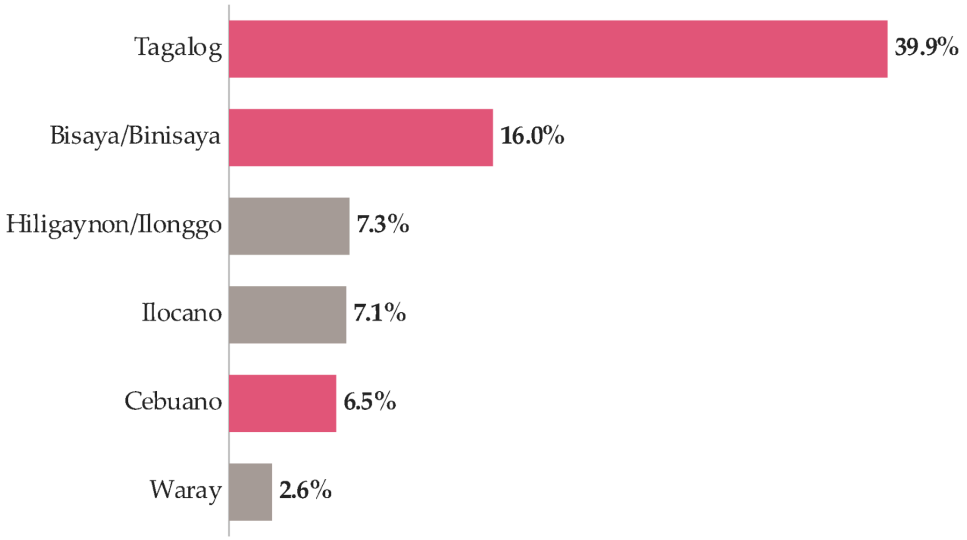
Primary Users

RELAYA is designed for Filipino remote professionals who deal directly with international clients or teammates in English video calls, such as freelancers, developers, virtual assistants, designers, and consultants. Many of them understand the client well. The difficulty is speaking, which means building a clear English sentence quickly enough while the call moves on. IT-BPM employees also work in

English, but their employers usually decide which tools may join client calls, so we reach them later through the Teams tier rather than in the first market.

In the Philippines, the language most often spoken at home is Tagalog, followed by Bisaya/Binisaya and Cebuano, which are the languages our first users naturally mix with English (PSA, 2023). The market is sized in the Market Analysis section.

Figure 2. Language or dialect generally spoken at home, share of Philippine households, 2020



Source: PSA (2023), 2020 Census of Population and Housing.

Paying Customers

The initial paying customer is the same person as the primary user. We expect individual freelancers and remote professionals to pay for tools that directly affect their income, since they tend to be early adopters of productivity software. Our pricing survey tests this (see Pricing Validation). Over time, a secondary paying customer may be small teams or agencies that want to standardize communication across a distributed workforce. This team tier is not the initial focus but is a plausible direction after individual adoption is established.

Secondary Users and Beneficiaries

RELAYA can also benefit Filipino students in English-medium online classes, presentations held over video calls, or even casual video calls to international people

where they need to speak clearly under time pressure. This group is secondary and is not part of the pilot.

VI. VALUE PROPOSITION

The value proposition was developed by considering why a person would choose RELAYA over existing alternatives such as Grammarly, Google Translate, ChatGPT, Gemini, meeting translators such as Talo, or simply speaking English themselves.

These tools address related language and communication needs, but they are not designed around the same problem.

- **Grammarly** mainly corrects and improves writing that the user has already formulated.
- **Google Translate** converts content from one language to another.
- **ChatGPT** and **Gemini** can generate or rewrite sentences, but they do not work inside a live call and have no approval gate before anything is spoken.
- **Meeting translators** such as Talo, now part of Palabra.ai, translate speech between languages directly.
- **Otter** and **Fireflies** focus on transcription and meeting summaries.

Google has also announced live speech translation inside Google Meet, powered by Gemini 3.5 Live Translate, covering more than 70 languages in a private preview for selected Google Workspace customers (McNeal, 2026). It translates what a speaker says from one language into another. The coverage we reviewed does not mention Filipino, Cebuano, or mixed-language speech, and it does not rebuild the user's intended sentence for approval before it is spoken. Because RELAYA works beside any meeting app and joins calls through its own agent, it does not depend on any one provider's translation features, and we will monitor how Google handles mixed-language input.

The difference from meeting translators is the job itself. Talo translates the words a person says while RELAYA makes sure what the user meant comes out right. Our users already speak English and understand their clients. They need clarity and control on hard moments, not an interpreter for the whole call.

Our team identified four layers of value in RELAYA's value proposition:

1. RELAYA accepts input that may be incomplete, messy, or code-switched, and reconstructs it into a clear sentence that the user can review and approve. The approved sentence is then said by the user, or spoken by the RELAYA agent on whichever platform the meeting uses.

2. RELAYA reduces the mental effort of formulating responses in a second language under pressure. Instead of translating thoughts in their head while the call moves on, users can express their ideas naturally and let RELAYA help with the delivery.

3. RELAYA can help reduce a recurring communication barrier in professional settings. For example, a freelancer may be able to respond to a client more clearly during a call about project scope, pricing, or requirements.

4. RELAYA does not treat code-switching or a user's natural way of thinking as something that needs to be corrected. It helps users communicate clearly without requiring them to give up their own voice or control. Say it yourself mode keeps the user's own voice in the conversation, and a planned Preserve my voice setting will let users decide how closely the sentence follows their original wording.

The client's side. RELAYA's value also depends on how the client receives it. The agent is labeled, speaks only approved sentences, and never pretends to be the user, and users who prefer their own voice can use Say it yourself mode, where the client simply hears the user. How clients rate each mode is one of the first things we test (see Validation Plan).

VII. BUSINESS MODEL

RELAYA will use a **freemium subscription model** with three tiers: **Free, Paid Individual, and Teams**. The tiers use a token system to manage access to RELAYA's reconstruction engine. A **token** is the unit that meters how much of Relaya's reconstruction engine a user can access. Tokens are not currency and are not purchased directly. They are a way of pacing usage so that the free tier can serve a large number of people without becoming a cost burden, and so that paid tiers can offer genuinely higher ceilings without being unlimited.

FREE TIER

The free tier exists so that anyone can try Relaya without friction and so that the product spreads through word of mouth rather than paid advertising. It is intentionally generous enough to be useful but limited enough to make the paid tier meaningful for daily users. What free users get:

- Context Guard and both delivery modes: Say it yourself on any platform, and Speak for me on Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams.
- 60 reconstructions per month, with at most 15 in any six-hour window.
- Up to 30 minutes of active agent presence per meeting session and up to eight agent sessions per month (four hours), on Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams.
- Say it yourself mode, which uses reconstructions only and no agent time.

A token is used each time the user records an input and RELAYA reconstructs it. When the six-hour window or the monthly pool is used up, reconstruction pauses until it resets. The user can still speak in the meeting with their own microphone.

Meeting time is limited separately. When a session reaches 30 minutes, or the four monthly sessions are used, the RELAYA agent leaves the meeting. The user's own microphone and video continue to work normally. These caps are starting values, and the pilot will tune them against measured costs and conversion.

The free tier will also serve as RELAYA's main acquisition channel. Instead of relying more on paid advertising, the team wants users to try the product, find it useful, and recommend it to others.

PAID INDIVIDUAL TIER

The paid tier is intended for professionals who use RELAYA regularly as part of their work. Paid users will receive:

- Up to 1,000 reconstructions and 30 hours of agent presence per month, with no six-hour windows (the fair-use ceiling).
- Longer meeting sessions, up to 2 hours of active agent presence per session.
- A saved personal glossary of names, product terms, technical vocabulary, and frequent phrases, carried across calls (added after the pilot).
- Higher-quality model settings for reconstruction.
- An optional history of approved sentences that the user can export.

TEAMS TIER

The Teams tier is intended for small agencies, distributed teams, and organizations whose members regularly communicate with international clients or colleagues.

The initial team package will support **up to five members under one subscription**. Each member will have their own RELAYA agent in meetings while maintaining the same transparent AI identity used by individual users.

The Teams tier will include:

- Up to five member seats in the base package.
- Individual RELAYA agents for each member.
- A **shared team glossary** containing terms related to the team's products, clients, or technical work.
- Company-specific tone settings for client calls and internal meetings.
- Larger shared token pools designed for regular workday use.
- Retention controls and administrative visibility, including aggregate usage information without exposing individual sentences.
- Additional seats at an added per-seat cost.

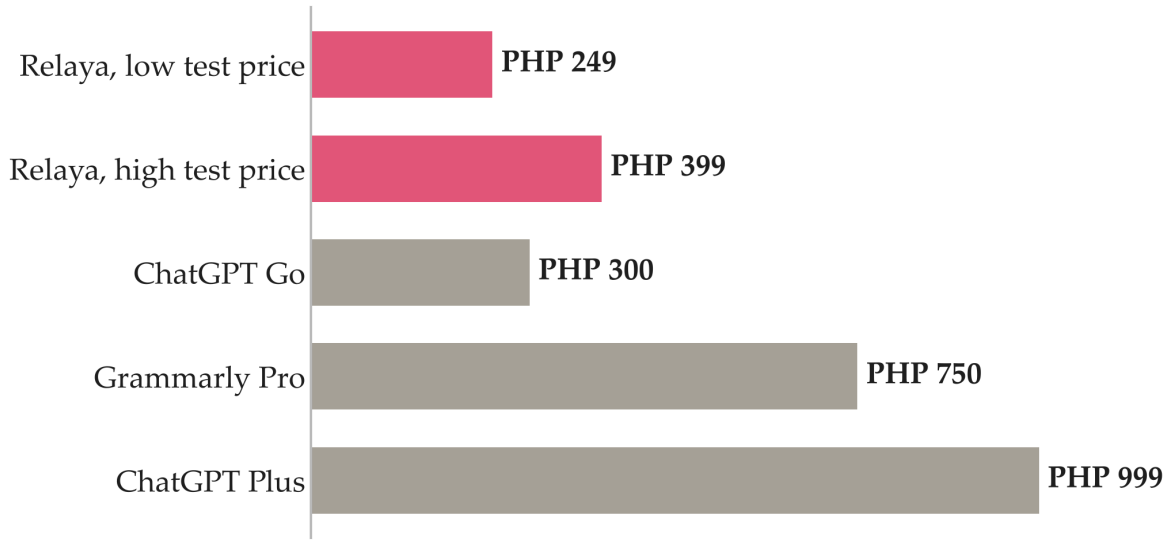
The initial test price is PHP 1,999 to PHP 2,999 per month for five seats, with additional seats priced separately. This is an initial assumption and will need to be validated with potential team customers.

PRICING LOGIC

For individual users, the initial test price is PHP 249 to PHP 399 per month. This is intended to remain affordable for Filipino freelancers and remote professionals while covering the cost of reconstruction and meeting sessions.

For comparison, the closest paid alternative for this job is a general AI assistant used beside the call. In the Philippines, ChatGPT Go is listed at PHP 300 per month and ChatGPT Plus at PHP 999 per month (OpenTheRank, 2026). Grammarly Pro, the common writing tool, is US$12 per month (about PHP 750). RELAYA's test range sits next to ChatGPT Go and well below ChatGPT Plus and Grammarly Pro (Figure 3), and unlike them it works inside the call.

Figure 3. Monthly price of RELAYA's test range compared with tools users would otherwise pay for



Sources: OpenTheRank (2026) for ChatGPT prices in the Philippines; Grammarly pricing page converted at PHP 62.54 per US$1 (OFX, 2026).

PRICING VALIDATION

The price range is a hypothesis. Before funding, we will survey 30 to 50 Filipino freelancers and virtual assistants in online freelancer communities. The survey asks the four Van Westendorp price questions (at what monthly price RELAYA would seem too cheap to trust, a bargain, getting expensive, and too expensive), how many English video calls they take with clients each week, and whether they would let a clearly labeled AI agent speak for them. We will also run a waitlist page that shows the price and ask one small agency for a letter of intent for the paid pilot. The results set the final price range before launch.

BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

The canvas below summarizes how RELAYA creates, delivers, and sustains value.

BLOCK	RELAYA
Problem	People know what they want to say but cannot build the English sentence before the conversation moves on. Translation and grammar tools convert or polish text; they do not rebuild meaning from mixed-language input.
Customer segments	**Beachhead**: Filipino freelance developers and virtual assistants who take weekly English video calls with international clients. **Later**: other remote professionals, then small Philippine teams and agencies.
Unique value proposition	Say what you mean in clear English, in your own voice, with your approval before anything is spoken.
Solution	A web panel that turns mixed-language speech into one clear English sentence, checked by Context Guard and delivered in the user's own voice (Say it yourself) or by a labeled agent on Google Meet, Zoom, and Microsoft Teams (Speak for me).
Channels	Word of mouth, Filipino freelancer communities, and creator demonstrations.
Revenue streams	Individual subscription (PHP 249 to 399 per month, main stream); Teams subscription (PHP 1,999 to 2,999 per month for five seats)
Cost structure	Speech-to-text, language model, text-to-speech, cloud agent sessions, meeting-platform test accounts, and support. Development is contributed by the team.
Key metrics	Approved without edits (60% or higher), response time, week-4 retention (25%), monthly users (300+ within six months of launch), free-to-paid rate (3% floor, 5% plan), cost per active user.
Unfair advantage	Accuracy data by input category from our tests and pilots, Tagalog-English and Bisaya-English test sets, and the approval-gate design.

UNIT ECONOMICS

The tables below build the monthly variable cost of serving one user from its parts, so each figure can be recomputed. Speech-to-text and language model prices are Groq's published rates. The agent-hour cost and token counts are our planning assumptions, which we will replace with figures logged from the first version and the pilot. Development is done by the team, and support is a fixed cost, so neither is included here.

Table 4. Variable cost per unit of use

Cost line	Unit	Basis	Cost (PHP)
Speech-to-text	Per recorded clip	Whisper Large v3 at US$0.111 per audio hour; Groq bills at least 10 seconds per request; we assume 15 billed seconds per clip	0.029
Intent reconstruction	Per reconstruction	gpt-oss-120b at US$0.15 per million input and US$0.60 per million output tokens; we assume 2,500 input and 600 output tokens	0.046
Total per reconstruction		**Speech-to-text plus intent reconstruction**	**0.075**
Agent hour	Per hour in a meeting	Cloud headless-browser session, including local text-to-speech on the same server; team assumption of US$0.08	5.00
Payment processing	Per paid month	Team assumption	4% of price

Exchange rate PHP 62.54 per US$1 (OFX, 2026).

Table 5. Monthly variable cost and margin by user type

User type	Agent hours	Reconstructions	Cost per month (PHP)	Margin at PHP 249	Margin at PHP 399
Free, typical	1	40	8.0	–	–
Free, at cap	4	60	24.5	–	–
Light	3	80	21.0	88%	91%
Typical	8	200	55.0	74%	82%
Heavy	24	600	165.0	30%	55%
Fair-use ceiling	30	1,000	225.0	6%	40%

Cost = agent hours × PHP 5.00 + reconstructions × PHP 0.075. Margin = (price × 0.96 − cost) ÷ price.

Each row follows from the unit costs. For example, a typical user costs 8 × PHP 5.00 + 200 × PHP 0.075 = PHP 55 per month. Agent time is about three-quarters of that cost, so the agent-hour assumption matters most, and Say it yourself mode avoids it entirely. At an average paid price of PHP 324, a typical paying user contributes about PHP 256 a month after variable costs and payment fees. The free tier pays for itself if at least 3.0% of users pay when free users behave typically, or

about 8.7% if every free user reaches the cap. Our planning rate of 5% is above the typical case but below the worst case, so the pilot will measure both conversion and free-tier use before the caps are final.

When the first version is built, we will log the actual token counts, billed seconds per clip, and cost of one agent hour, and update Tables 4 and 5 before the pilot. Because Say it yourself is the default mode, real agent hours per user are likely to be lower than the profiles above assume.

PATH TO SUSTAINABILITY

Positive margins per user do not by themselves make RELAYA sustainable, because fixed costs must also be covered. Table 6 projects months 7 to 24 after funding under three scenarios. All use the unit costs above, an average paid price of PHP 324, and fixed cash costs of about PHP 14,500 per month after launch: a cloud baseline for session management, monitoring, and a database (PHP 3,000), support and billing tools (PHP 2,000), marketing and community (PHP 6,000), legal, compliance, and permits (PHP 2,000), and domain and platform test accounts (PHP 1,500).

Table 6. Projection for months 7 to 24 after funding, three scenarios

	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Paid conversion	3%	5%	7%
Monthly users at M12 / M18 / M24	300 / 1,000 / 1,600	500 / 2,000 / 3,000	800 / 3,500 / 5,000
Paying users at M24	48	150	350
Monthly revenue at M24	PHP 15,600	PHP 48,600	PHP 113,400
Monthly cash costs at M24	PHP 30,200	PHP 47,500	PHP 75,500
Monthly result at M24	−PHP 14,600	+PHP 1,100	+PHP 37,900
Revenue first covers cash costs	Not within 24 months	Month 23	Month 14
Peak outside funding needed after this ask (M7 to M24)	About PHP 262,000	About PHP 130,000	About PHP 59,000

Three conclusions follow. First, in the base case RELAYA covers its cash costs from about month 23, still without team salaries. Second, below about 3% conversion the free tier uses up the margin from paying users, and RELAYA would not break even at any scale. If the pilot shows conversion near that level, we will tighten the free tier, for example to Say it yourself mode only, before spending on marketing. Third, until break-even, Phase 3 and the months after it depend on grants, prizes, and the paid pilot, not on subscription revenue alone.

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION

The team will focus on three main channels:

1. Word of mouth - Users who find RELAYA useful can recommend it to other freelancers, remote workers, and multilingual professionals.
2. Online communities - The team will participate in Filipino freelancing communities, remote work groups, and other spaces where potential users already discuss working with international clients.
3. Creator collaborations and Brand Advertising - RELAYA can work with Filipino creators who discuss freelancing, remote work, and working in a second language. These collaborations can demonstrate the product through actual use rather than scripted testimonials.

RETENTION

First, RELAYA can become part of a user's normal workflow. A user who relies on it for regular client calls and team meetings may continue using it as long as the reconstruction remains useful and consistent.

Second, personalization can make RELAYA more useful over time. Users can build a personal glossary and, with their approval, allow their preferred phrasing and vocabulary to influence future reconstructions. Users can also export their glossary and approved sentence history, so personalization is intended to benefit the user rather than prevent them from leaving the service.

MAJOR COSTS

The largest operating costs will come from:

- Speech-to-text
- Intent reconstruction
- Text-to-speech
- Cloud meeting-agent sessions on Google Meet, Zoom, and Microsoft Teams
- Upkeep of the meeting-platform adapters when the platforms change their interfaces
- Customer support and community management

Inference and meeting agent sessions are expected to be the main variable costs because they increase with usage. RELAYA will manage these costs through caching, tiered model selection, and the token system.

The free tier can use lower-cost model configurations, while paid users can receive higher-quality configurations. The token system also limits the amount of reconstruction and agent usage a single free user can consume.

SCALABILITY

RELAYA can scale in three ways without rebuilding its engine.

- **More users:** agent sessions move to the cloud and are metered by the token system.
- **More meeting platforms:** each new platform needs only a small adapter, because the engine, panel, and approval gate are shared.
- **More Philippine/Foreign languages:** Hiligaynon and Ilocano, the next most common home languages after Tagalog and Bisaya/Cebuano (Figure 2), can be added later. Each new language needs speech recognition checks and evaluation, but it reuses the same reconstruction workflow.

VIII. MARKET ANALYSIS

We size the Philippine market from the bottom up, using published workforce counts and our test price of PHP 249 to PHP 399 per month. The Total Addressable Market (TAM) is about **3.4 million** English-working professionals: 1.9 million IT-BPM workers in 2025 (Desiderio, 2026) plus about 1.5 million registered online freelancers (Manila Bulletin, 2025). The Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM) matches our primary users and leaves out IT-BPM employees, whose employers choose their tools. There are about **690,000** freelancers who already use

generative AI at work, which applies the 46% monthly generative-AI use rate among Filipino workers (Cordero, 2024; Jobstreet by SEEK, 2024) to the 1.5 million freelancers. Our Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) is **1,000 to 3,500 monthly users** in the first twelve months after launch, which is 0.15% to 0.5% of the SAM.

Table 7. Market size, Philippines

Tier	Who	People	Value per year	Basis
TAM	IT-BPM employees plus online freelancers who work in English	about 3.4 million	PHP 10.2 to 16.3 billion	1.9M + 1.5M, at PHP 249 to 399 per month
SAM	Freelancers who already use generative AI at work	about 690,000	PHP 2.1 to 3.3 billion	1.5M x 46%
SOM	Reachable in the first 12 months after launch	1,000 to 3,500	about PHP 0.2 to 0.7 million	0.15% to 0.5% of SAM; 5% paying at PHP 324

Three cautions apply. The freelancer count is a media-reported estimate of registered freelancers, and the Philippine Statistics Authority has not yet released its own count. The two groups in the TAM may overlap, and the overlap is not removed. The 46% rate comes from a survey of Filipino workers in general and is applied here to freelancers as an assumption, and not everyone in the SAM takes English video calls. Our objective of 300 monthly users within six months of launch is about 0.04% of the SAM, so the SOM is conservative. The 5% paying rate is a planning assumption, and the 3% floor below which the free tier stops paying for itself is set out in the Business Model section.

The secondary market is Filipino students and other users who speak English in online classes and presentations. We have not sized it yet. This plan targets the Philippines only. Other Asian and non-native English-speaking markets are a later direction and are not sized here.

Demand and trend are supported by five signals.

- **AI is already normal at work.** 46% of Filipino workers use generative AI monthly, compared with 39% globally, and 50% of them use it for writing tasks (Cordero, 2024; Jobstreet by SEEK, 2024).
- **Speaking lags writing.** The Philippines scores 603 in writing and 539 in speaking on the EF English Proficiency Index (EF Education First, 2025).

- **Code-switching is normal, not an error.** Tagalog-English mixing is described as extremely common (Herrera et al., 2022), and the Bisaya/Binisaya and Cebuano speakers who mix with English make up 22.5% of households (PSA, 2023).
- **The conversation does not wait.** Turn gaps stay within about 250 milliseconds of the cross-language average across ten languages (Stivers et al., 2009), which is shorter than the time needed to compose a sentence in a second language.
- **AI participants in calls are already accepted.** Meeting translators such as Talo already join Zoom, Google Meet, and Microsoft Teams calls from a pasted meeting link and translate live in more than 60 languages (Palabra.ai, n.d.-a). Palabra.ai reports that Talo has supported over 10,000 users (Palabra.ai, n.d.-b), so hosts and clients are getting used to clearly labeled AI participants.

Competitor Landscape

- **Translation tools**, such as Google Translate and DeepL, render sentences from one language into another. They assume a single source language and focus on fidelity to what was said.
- **Grammar and writing assistants**, such as Grammarly and similar tools, correct and polish English. They assume the user is already writing in English well enough to produce a first draft.
- **General AI assistants**, such as ChatGPT and Gemini, can produce polished sentences when asked, but they have no built-in workflow for a live call and no approval gate before anything is spoken.
- **Meeting translators**, such as Talo, which Palabra.ai has acquired, join Zoom, Google Meet, and Microsoft Teams calls and translate speech between languages in real time. They solve a language barrier. They do not reconstruct intent from code-switched input or ask for approval first. Otter and Fireflies record and summarize meetings. They do not help the user produce a better sentence at the moment.
- **Google Meet live translation** (private preview, June 2026) translates speech between more than 70 languages inside Meet. It translates what a speaker says; it does not rebuild the user's meaning from mixed-language input or ask for approval first (McNeal, 2026).
- **Speech translation devices**. Dedicated hardware from companies such as iFlytek and Timekettle focuses on face-to-face translation.

RELAYA does not aim to replace existing communication tools. It builds on an established market of AI-assisted communication tools that are already widely used and feasible. RELAYA addresses the gap they leave open, which is a real-time, intent-driven communication from code-switched input with user approval.

IX. OPERATIONS PLAN

There is a difference between the cost of building a first working version and the cost of running a real product at scale. RELAYA is designed so that the riskiest assumptions are tested before anything is built, and so that the first version can be built by the team on free tiers and their own machines, at or near zero cash cost. The funding request in the Financial Requirement section covers the cloud infrastructure, controlled test, and pilot that follow.

Proposed Architecture

RELAYA is designed as a web app panel with an optional meeting agent. The user opens the RELAYA panel in a browser tab beside the meeting, speaks into it, and reviews the proposed sentence. In Say it yourself mode, the user then reads the sentence aloud, and nothing else joins the call. In Speak for me mode, the agent speaks the approved sentence into the call through its own audio channel and under its own participant identity, with a display name such as “Janelle’s Relaya (AI).” A Chrome side panel for Google Meet, which could mute the user and start recording with one key, is a later option.

How the RELAYA Agent Joins the Call

The RELAYA agent is a headless browser session, controlled by a backend service, that joins the meeting the way a guest joins from a link. A small adapter for each platform handles joining, the display name, and audio routing, while the engine, panel, and approval gate are shared. The Google Meet adapter is built first, followed by Zoom and Microsoft Teams. During development, the headless browser runs on the team’s own machines at no cost. For the pilot, the same architecture runs on a cloud server with session management, and this is where recurring cost begins.

The agent's audio output is generated by the text-to-speech stage of the pipeline, played through the headless browser's audio channel, and heard by the other participants as the agent's voice.

Each platform sets its own rules for automated participants, so each adapter follows the route that platform allows. On Google Meet, the official Meet Media API is in developer preview and requires every participant to be enrolled, so the agent joins as a labeled guest through Meet's web interface and the host admits it. On Zoom, apps built with the Meeting SDK that join meetings hosted by other accounts have needed an "On Behalf Of" token since March 2, 2026; the token comes from a user who has authorized the app, and the app can join only after that user is in the meeting (Zoom, n.d.). For RELAYA, that user is the RELAYA user, who is always in the call, so the Zoom adapter is built as an authorized Meeting SDK app. On Microsoft Teams, bots that handle live audio directly must run on Windows Server with Microsoft's real-time media library. We will compare that route with joining as a guest and with commercial meeting-bot services that already support all three platforms, and choose the one with the lowest upkeep. Before the pilot, we will review each platform's terms of service. Hosts and client organizations can still refuse outside participants, and platforms change their interfaces, so adapter upkeep is a standing team task. If the agent cannot join, Say it yourself mode keeps RELAYA fully usable on that call.

LAYER	COMPONENT
User Panel	React, Vite, TypeScript, Tailwind
Backend Orchestration	Vercel Serverless Functions
Speech-to-text	Groq Whisper Large v3
Instant Reconstruction	Groq-hosted language model with a fixed output format
Text-to-speech	Kokoro-js (Speak for me only)
Agent infrastructure	Playwright headless browser with adapters for Google Meet, Zoom, and Microsoft Teams; team machines during development, cloud server in the pilot
Hosting	Vercel
Database	None in the first version

Authentication	Added before the paid pilot

Reconstruction Pipeline

1. Speech-to-text - The user holds a key in the RELAYA panel, speaks in any mix of Filipino and English, and releases. The audio clip goes to one server pipeline that sends it to the speech recognition engine. The language mode can be pinned in the panel so the user stays in control.

2. Intent reconstruction - The same pipeline passes the transcript straight to a large language model with a fixed output format and low temperature. The model returns one proposed sentence, the meaning facts Context Guard needs (numbers, dates, names, negation, hedges, and commitments), a confidence level, and any terms it could not resolve.

3. Text-to-speech (Speak for me only) - The sentence on screen is converted to audio with kokoro-js while the user reads it. The audio is tied to that exact text, discarded if the text changes, and played only after approval, through the headless browser's audio channel. No text is sent to a paid text-to-speech service.

Language support for Cebuano

Whisper's published language list includes Tagalog but not Cebuano, so Bisaya-English input is the largest technical unknown. Milestone 0 therefore comes before any building. We will collect 100 to 150 consented clips of Tagalog-English and Bisaya-English speech from at least 10 speakers, transcribe them by hand, and compare Groq's Whisper Large v3, Google's Chirp 2 model, which lists Cebuano and Filipino (Google Cloud, n.d.), and Meta's Massively Multilingual Speech models, which also list Cebuano (Meta AI, 2023). We will measure the overall error rate and, more importantly, accuracy on the words that matter most. Until Bisaya-English accuracy is shown to match Tagalog-English, RELAYA is demonstrated with Tagalog-English input and Bisaya is described as supported with known limits. If no engine reaches 95% accuracy on the critical words for Bisaya, Bisaya moves out of the first version.

Context Guard

A sentence is treated as high-risk if either what the user said or the proposed sentence contains numbers or number words (such as tatlo, upat, or alas-tres), dates or time words (bukas, ugma, next week), negation (hindi, wala, huwag, dili, ayaw), hedges (siguro, baka, yata, basin, tingali, or mga meaning "about"), commitment words (promise, sure, will deliver), or a name from the names list. When RELAYA cannot tell whether a sentence is high-risk, it treats it as high-risk.

Privacy

The first version will store nothing. Raw audio is processed for transcription and discarded. Transcripts and suggestions live in browser memory only. There is no database, no session persistence, and no account system until the paid pilot. API keys live only in server-side environment variables and are never sent to the browser.

Say it yourself mode is the most private. RELAYA processes only what the user records in the panel, and nothing joins the call. In Speak for me mode, the agent joins transparently, with a clear display name, and only when the user plans to use it. It does not speak without explicit user approval. Because it is a participant, the agent technically receives the meeting's audio, but RELAYA does not transcribe, store, or summarize what other participants say, and the only audio the agent produces is the approved sentence.

Development Milestones

The build plan has thirteen milestones, starting with Milestone 0, which tests the largest unknown before anything is built. Milestones 1 to 7 produce the first working version with Say it yourself mode. Milestones 8 to 10 add Speak for me on Google Meet, Zoom, and Microsoft Teams. Milestones 11 and 12 add clear failure states and a recorded walkthrough.

Milestone	Scope	Purpose
0	Compare speech recognition on Tagalog-English and Bisaya-English audio	Close the largest unknown before building anything
1	Project scaffold and first deploy	Live URL for manual testing from day one

Milestone	Scope	Purpose
2	Push-to-talk capture in the panel	Hold to record, release to process
3	One server pipeline from speech-to-text to reconstruction	No extra round trip between steps
4	One-sentence reconstruction with meaning facts	The product layer
5	Context Guard with in-place highlights and one-tap fixes	Meaning protection
6	Per-call names list and tone setting	Protect names; one tone choice per call
7	Say it yourself display and timing logs	First complete version; every stage measured
8	Speak for me on Google Meet: agent, audio prepared during review, Stop button	The agent on the first platform
9	Platform adapter layer and Zoom adapter (authorized Meeting SDK app)	Same engine on a second platform
10	Microsoft Teams adapter	Third platform
11	Failure states: Unsure, agent not admitted, network errors	Trust behavior under uncertainty
12	Recorded walkthrough	Backup for demonstrations

Table 8. Planned timing of each feature and activity

Feature or activity	Planned timing
Problem interviews and simulated two-mode test (Stages 1 and 2)	Pre-funding
Speech recognition comparison (Milestone 0)	Pre-funding
Prototype: web panel, pipeline, reconstruction, Context Guard, Say it yourself, and Speak for me on Google Meet (Milestones 1 to 8)	Pre-funding
Cloud agent hosting	Month 1
Controlled test (Stage 4)	Month 2
Zoom and Microsoft Teams adapters (Milestones 9 and 10)	Months 3 and 4
Pilot with 30+ users (Stage 5)	Months 4 and 5

Feature or activity	Planned timing
Accuracy report and paid pilot	Month 6
Accounts, token metering, and self-serve billing	Launch, month 7 (the paid pilot is invoiced manually)
Saved personal glossary and Preserve my voice	After the pilot
Teams tier features	After month 12

Roadmap Beyond the First Version

- First, the agent will move to a cloud server. This is what makes the product usable by more than one user at a time, and it is the main cost driver in the validation phase. The agent session service needs to run headless browsers, manage session state, and support concurrent meetings. This is well-understood infrastructure, but it is not free at scale.

- Second, the Zoom and Microsoft Teams adapters. They plug into the adapter layer built in Milestone 9 and are tested with pilot users on the platforms their clients actually use.

- Third, workspace features. Shared glossaries, team tone settings, retention controls, and administrative visibility. These are the natural commercial extensions of the personal product.

Validation Plan

Because RELAYA has not yet been tested with users, the plan tests the riskiest assumptions before money and months go into building. Each stage answers one question, and the gates in Table 9 decide what changes if the answer is no.

Stage 1: Problem interviews (pre-funding, two weeks). We will interview 15 to 20 people in the beachhead segment about past behavior rather than opinions, for example: “Walk me through your last video call with a client,” “When did you last struggle to say something the way you meant it, and what did you do?” and “How often did that happen in the past month?”

Stage 2: Simulated two-mode test (pre-funding, 10 to 12 users). In mock client calls, a hidden teammate types the English sentence from the user’s Taglish or Bisaya,

standing in for the engine. Each user tries three versions: answering unaided, reading the sentence aloud (Say it yourself), and having a second Meet participant named "Relaya (AI)" speak it (Speak for me). Delays of 3, 8, and 15 seconds are added on purpose to find how long clients will wait. Mock clients rate clarity, professionalism, trust, and the user's competence. This test shows which mode users and clients prefer and how much delay they accept; it does not show speech recognition accuracy or real-world demand.

Stage 3: Prototype build (pre-funding, Milestones 0 to 8). The speech recognition comparison, reconstruction and Context Guard tested on about 100 utterances with planted changes, timing of every stage from a Philippine connection, and Speak for me on Google Meet.

Stage 4: Controlled test (month 2, 12 to 20 users). Each participant handles eight scenarios written on cards in Filipino or Bisaya, two each on uncertainty, negation, numbers and dates, and names and commitments. Each is answered three ways, in varied order: unaided, with ChatGPT beside the call, and with RELAYA. We record the client's waiting time, time to a complete answer, meaning accuracy rated by blind bilingual raters, clarity rated by a fluent listener, and critical errors.

Stage 5: Pilot (months 4 and 5). At least 30 users try RELAYA in real client calls, leading to the month-6 accuracy report.

Table 9. Go/no-go gates for the validation plan

Decision	Condition
Keep Speak for me as a main mode	At least 60% of mock clients rate it acceptable, and users choose it at least 40% of the time
Position Speak for me for one-way updates and accessibility	Fewer than 50% of mock clients rate it acceptable
Simplify Context Guard's display	False alarms above 15% while the catch rate stays at 95% or more; never on high-risk sentences without catch-rate evidence
Narrow the market	Fewer than 40% of interviewees meet the problem at least twice a month; focus on scoping, pricing, and sales calls
Change speech recognition engine or drop Bisaya	Another engine is more accurate on critical words; if none reaches 95% on Bisaya, Bisaya leaves the first version

Decision	Condition
Pause or rethink	RELAYA is not clearer or faster than ChatGPT beside the call, critical errors stay above 2%, or fewer than 30% would pay PHP 249

Implementation Timeline

Table 10. Proposed implementation plan, 24 months from funding (blue: before funding, no cost; pink: funded by the ask; grey: starts only if the gate is met)

Activity	Before funding	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6	M7 to M12	M13 to M24
Interviews, simulated test, speech recognition comparison									
Prototype: panel, engine, Context Guard, Say it yourself									
Prototype: Speak for me on Google Meet									
Cloud agent hosting									
Controlled test									
Zoom and Microsoft Teams adapters									
Pilot with 30+ users									
Accuracy report and paid pilot									
Public launch, 300+ users									
Teams tier									

X. FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

RELAYA is designed so that its first version can be built at or near zero cash cost. During development, the agent runs on the team's own machines, the AI services run on free tiers, and text-to-speech runs locally. This lets the team build and test the core product before spending money, and keeps the funding request focused on what requires cash.

The funding request below is organized into phases, and only Phase 2 is money our team is asking for in this competition.

Phase 1: Concept Design and Pre-Funding Validation (Current Stage)

This phase is covered by the team's own time and free tools. The product design, architecture, cost model, and validation plan in this paper are its first output. Before funding, the team will also run the problem interviews, the simulated two-mode test, and the speech recognition comparison, and build the prototype, including Speak for me on Google Meet (Stages 1 to 3).

What this phase produces is evidence and a working prototype: whether the problem is frequent enough, which delivery mode users and clients accept, and whether Filipino and Bisaya speech can be recognized accurately enough to build on.

Phase 2, Build, Validation, and Pilot

Funding: **PHP 80,000**, covering the first six months after funding.

This is the only phase that requires external funding. The prototype will not yet have been tested with real users in real client calls. This phase moves it from the team's own machines to a cloud server, adds the agent on Zoom and Microsoft Teams, and answers three questions: whether the product is genuinely useful, whether the agent holds up in real meetings across platforms, and whether people will pay for it.

Use of funds	Amount (PHP)	Share
Cloud server for meeting agents at pilot scale, six months	16,000	20%
AI model usage on paid plans with confirmed data-retention terms	8,000	10%

Use of funds	Amount (PHP)	Share
Meeting-platform test accounts (Zoom and Microsoft Teams) for adapter testing	8,000	10%
Pilot user incentives: 32 users at PHP 500 each, to keep 30+ active	16,000	20%
Privacy review: privacy notice, consent form, and terms under the Data Privacy Act	12,000	15%
Community outreach and content to recruit the controlled test and pilot	8,000	10%
Business name registration, domain, and payment setup	4,000	5%
Contingency	8,000	10%
Total ask	**80,000**	**100%**

The six-month ask buys what our MVP and Validation Objectives require: cloud hosting for the prototype, Speak for me on Zoom and Microsoft Teams, a controlled test, a pilot with 30 or more users, a measured rate of sentences approved without edits (target 60% or higher), an accuracy report by input category, and at least one paid pilot. The cloud and AI lines follow the unit economics above.

Phase 3: Public Launch (months 7 to 12)
Estimated requirement after subscription revenue: About PHP 70,000 to PHP 97,000

This phase moves RELAYA from a validated first version to a public product with paying users, sized for 300 to 800 monthly users by month 12. Development remains with the team. The figures below come from the same model as Table 6.

Category	Estimated cost, months 7 to 12
Usage costs: agent sessions, models, and payment fees, scaling with users	PHP 10,300 to PHP 33,700
Cloud baseline: session management, monitoring, and database	PHP 18,000
Customer support and billing tools	PHP 12,000
Marketing and community outreach for the first paying users	PHP 36,000
Legal, compliance, and permits for paid subscriptions	PHP 12,000

Category	Estimated cost, months 7 to 12
Domain and platform test accounts	PHP 9,000
Contingency (10%)	PHP 9,700 to PHP 12,100
Total cash costs	**PHP 107,000 to PHP 132,700**
Less subscription revenue	PHP 10,200 to PHP 62,600
Outside funding needed (grants, prizes, paid pilot)	**PHP 70,100 to PHP 96,800**

After Month 12: Teams Tier

No funding is requested for this stage. It is funded from subscription revenue where revenue allows and from grants or prizes otherwise; in the base case, monthly revenue covers cash costs from about month 23 (Table 6). This stage adds the Teams tier described in the business model, with shared glossaries and agent sessions for small Philippine teams and agencies.

Notes on the Funding Request

The funding request is deliberately small and staged, so that each phase produces evidence that justifies the next. The team tests the riskiest assumptions and builds the first version with its own time and free tools before spending money. The validation phase asks for PHP 80,000 to run RELAYA on real infrastructure. Later phases are funded from revenue as it grows and from grants or prizes until then, and each starts only after its gate is met. The team does not assume external investment beyond the amounts listed. Amounts are in Philippine pesos. Where a US dollar price is quoted, it is converted at PHP 62.54 per US$1 (OFX, 2026). Our request in this competition is the PHP 80,000 for Phase 2 only. Phase 3 is shown to explain what the validation makes possible.

REFERENCES

Brysbaert, M. (2019). How many words do we read per minute? A review and meta-analysis of reading rate. *Journal of Memory and Language, 109*, Article 104047. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jml.2019.104047

Cordero, T. (2024, November 20). AI adoption at 46% among Filipino workers—Jobstreet study. *GMA Integrated News.*

https://gmanetwork.com/news/money/companies/927674/ai-adoption-at-46-among-filipino-workers-jobstreet-study/story

Desiderio, L. (2026, January 29). IT-BPM revenues breach $40 billion mark. *The Philippine Star.* https://www.philstar.com/business/2026/01/29/2504140/it-bpm-revenues-breach-40-billion-mark/amp/

EF Education First. (2025). EF English Proficiency Index 2025: Philippines. https://www.ef.com/epi/regions/asia/philippines/

Google Cloud. (n.d.). *Cloud Speech-to-Text V2 supported languages* [Web page]. https://docs.cloud.google.com/speech-to-text/docs/languages

Herrera, M., Aich, A., & Parde, N. (2022). TweetTaglish: A dataset for investigating Tagalog-English code-switching. In *Proceedings of the 13th Conference on Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC 2022).* https://preview.aclanthology.org/moar-dois/2022.lrec-1.225.pdf

Jobstreet by SEEK. (2024). Decoding global talent AI 2024: Gen AI edition: Shifting work preferences in the age of GenAI. https://ph.employer.seek.com/market-insights/decoding-global-talent-ai-2024

Manila Bulletin. (2025, January 7). The Filipino online freelancers: Digital workforce of the world. https://mb.com.ph/2025/1/7/the-filipino-online-freelancers-digital-workforce-of-the-world

McNeal, R. (2026, June 9). Google Translate and Meet are getting a big-time language translation boost. *Android Authority.* https://www.androidauthority.com/google-translate-meet-live-translation-3676026/

Meta AI. (2023). *facebook/mms-1b-all* [Model card]. Hugging Face. https://huggingface.co/facebook/mms-1b-all

OFX. (2026, October 1). USD to PHP exchange rate [Web page]. https://www.ofx.com/en-sg/exchange-rates/usd-to-php/

OpenTheRank. (2026, October 8). *ChatGPT pricing in the Philippines* [Web page]. https://opentherank.com/ai-pricing/chatgpt/philippines/

Palabra.ai. (n.d.-a). Translate any video call live in 60+ languages [Web page]. https://www.palabra.ai/lp/calls

Palabra.ai. (n.d.-b). *TaloAI x Palabra.ai* [Customer story]. https://www.palabra.ai/customer-stories/taloai-x-palabra-ai

Philippine Statistics Authority. (2023). Press release on language/dialect generally spoken at home: 2020 Census of Population and Housing. https://psa.gov.ph/system/files/phcd/02%20-%20Press%20Release%20on%20Language_Dialect%20Generally%20Spoken%20at%20Home_030323_PMMJ_CRD.pdf

Stivers, T., Enfield, N. J., Brown, P., Englert, C., Hayashi, M., Heinemann, T., Hoymann, G., Rossano, F., de Ruiter, J. P., Yoon, K.-E., & Levinson, S. C. (2009). Universals and cultural variation in turn-taking in conversation. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 106(26), 10587–10592.* https://experts.illinois.edu/en/publications/universals-and-cultural-variation-in-turn-taking-in-conversation/

Zoom. (n.d.). *FAQ: Updates to Meeting SDK authorization* [Documentation]. Zoom Developer Platform. https://developers.zoom.us/docs/meeting-sdk/obf-faq/